THE NEW AGE UNIVERSITIES

CREATING FUTURE THROUGH TECHNOLOGY, INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Dynamism defines today's academic and professional environment. If India has to achieve its goal of doubling gross enrolment ratio (GER) from the current 26.3% to 50% by 2035, the Technology & Innovation has to play a big role. With artificial intelligence, robots, automation, socio-political movements, climate change etc. exercising a huge say in what now is an increasingly volatile, uncertain, complex and ambiguous world, the nature of jobs are constantly undergoing changes. Alive to the urgency of the scenario, India has a number of private universities keeping pace with the changing times. These New Age universities have developed a curriculum keeping in mind the most in demand skills that one should equip oneself with for the future in order to thrive in one's careers.

Indian brainpower, by occupying key positions, is playing a huge role in decision making of global consequence. The conditions are ripe for India to play an even more important part in the global knowledge system. The arena of Indian higher education is set to experience more fast-paced growth in the times to come – with growing interest being expressed by leading global universities and nations holding the top spot in the domain of higher education. India has caught the attention of the world with governments and universities from all over the world eager to collaborate and sign memoranda of understanding in the fields of research collaboration, joint degrees and initiatives to advance returns from higher education.

With the introduction of the NEP 2020, India has its eyes set on the goal of doubling gross enrolment rates from the current 26.3% to 50% by 2035. Majority Indian youth is enrolled in private colleges at the undergraduate level. The huge response to Private Universities as top choices among leading educational institutions in the country in **Common University Entrance Test (CUET)** is a testimony of growing influence of private universities among students in the country. **CUET** which is being conducted for the first time in the country for admission to undergraduate courses for the session 2022-23 in 86 universities, including central universities saw second highest number of applications received for any entrance examination in the country. As a private university, Galgotias University has received around 4 lakh applications under **CUET** scheme thus earning the distinction of being among the overall top 10 educational institutions in terms of applications received. According to a 2021 study published in the Journal of Higher Education Policy and Leadership Studies authored by Prof Furqan Qamar of Jamia Millia Islamia, private universities constitute over 30 per cent of the total higher education institutes in India. Leading the list of private Indian Universities are Galgotias University, Amity University, Manipal Academy of Higher Education, BITS, J.S.S. Academy of Technical Education, the LNM Institute of Information Technology, Dr. D. Y. Patil Vidyapeeth, Nirma University, Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham and Symbiosis International. Upholding the highest integrity, professionalism, and ethical values are the hallmarks of these new age universities.

TECHNOLOGY: SHAPING THE FUTURE

As technology advances, we see education progressing towards a better phase. In a world where technology is predicted to become smarter than it ever was, some see technological changes as a challenge. When academia incorporates new tech into the curriculum, it serves to train the youth to integrate ideas from multiple settings which will be crucial to address the problems of tomorrow. To have future ready youth, some of the institutes of higher education have developed a cross-disciplinary ecosystem designed to inculcate adaptability in the students. The courses being offered align with the concept of imparting key competencies to navigate the future of work and learning. The global scenario is complex today with unique problems and challenges which cannot be solved in the traditional academic silos but through a multidisciplinary ecosystem approach. Some



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